



Personal Information Managers (PIM)

- Pocket Informant:**
www.pocketinformant.com
- Agenda Fusion:**
www.developerone.com/demo/fusion5.htm
- ListPro:** www.iliumsoft.com
- SPB Pocket Plus:**
www.spbsoftwarehouse.com
- Password Managers**
- eWallet:** www.iliumsoft.com
- Nice Start:** www.trancreative.com
- Databases**
- SprintDB Pro:** www.kaione.com
- Office suites**
- SpreadCE:** www.byedesign.freeseve.co.uk

- PhatPad:** www.paragraph.com/phatpad.html
- ProWord:** <http://shop.store.yahoo.com/pilot-gearsw/proword.html>
- Messaging**
- OneMail:**
www.pocketpcportal.com/Onemail.htm
- Utilities**
- Resco File Manager:** www.resco-net.com
- Pocket Explorer:**
www.citadeldevelopment.com/products/pexplorer.aspx
- Pocket Hack Master:** http://www.pocket-gear.com/software_detail.asp?id=7258
- Battery Pack 2003:**
<http://www.omegaone.com/PocketPC/Battery-Pack.html>

- Must-haves**
- Icbar:** (<http://www.freewareppc.com/utilities/icbar.shtml>) Icbar is a freeware task bar and application manager that gives you greater control over all your running applications.
 - Microsoft Reader** (<http://www.microsoft.com/reader/>) : With the recent spate of free e-book releases from Microsoft and the ClearType font, Reader is a definite keeper.
 - Network Monitors:** Use GPRS Monitor (<http://www.softspb.com/products/gprsmonitor/>) to track data transfers via GPRS, CDMA or GSM networks or IP Dashboard (<http://www.hudsonmobile.com/products.html>) to quickly monitor the state of all your wireless and wired network connections.

Penbex

There is very little in the form of third-party tools for the Penbex operating system, at least for the English-speaking audience. The official Web site has a software download section that tries to cover major categories that would appeal to a user. Nevertheless, coverage is lacking and available applications have very basic functionality.

Pushpam HandsPC 1600

In desi hands

The handsPC 1600 from Pushpam is a colour PDA with a very average look. The body is metallic silver with chrome buttons. The stylus is plastic at the top and bottom with metal in between. It has five buttons; one of them is a four way button, which comes in handy while playing Tetris.

This model is powered by a Motorola DragonBall VZ33MHz processor, with 4 MB of ROM and 8 MB of RAM. The screen is 160 x 160 pixels and backlit. The device has a Compact Flash slot which stores MP3 files. The PDA runs on a Li-Polymer rechargeable battery.

Available on the 1600, is custom software for LIC agents. The pre-loaded applications are quite straightforward. The Infra-red port makes data transfer from both PC and cell phones easy. Syncing with a PC and transfer between PC and PDA is fast.

It was hard to enter an 8-letter word without a mistake—we had to refer to the manual. A sore area is applications, which are available only on the Penbex Web site. Battery life is good, though—approximately 7.5 hours. The device runs the Penbex OS, and the internal 8 MB memory may not be sufficient even for LIC and other insurance agents, at whom the device is targeted; you'll require an additional 128MB CF card that costs Rs 3,000.

If one is looking for a colour PDA as an upgrade, this is one of the alternatives, with local support available.

Price: Rs 14,700

+ Fast synching

- Entering text is difficult

Pushpam HandsPC 1600 B-

Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■



Pushpam HandsPC 1300

Excuse for a handheld

The HandsPC 1300 feels rather heavy. It sports a dual-tone finish, and has four buttons on the front face and two on the left side. The unit comes with a leather pouch.

The 1300 is powered by a Motorola Dragonball VZ328 processor at 33 MHz, and has 4 MB ROM and 16 MB SDRAM. The screen is 160 x 160 pixels, backlit. The unit's rectangular block design requires you to grip it firmly, since it is prone to slipping. It also lacks a speaker—instead, it only has a buzzer. There's an infra-red port which did not work with either a Sony Ericsson or a Siemens phone. However, the serial cable functioned smoothly.

The unit was sluggish—we tried to write the number '1' quickly, and only 70 per cent of it came up on the screen. There were problems in the battery department—it showed a full battery, but kept flashing a warning that the battery power was low and that the unit would shut down. This was after using it for just 3 hours.

The power cable is plugged in near the serial connector—this is an odd design; it increases wire clutter, and also renders simultaneous transferring of data and charging the unit impossible, if the PC is on the floor.

In all, the 1300 is expensive, at Rs 12,400—even if one takes into consideration the price of the customised LIC software.

Price: Rs 12,400

+ Fast synching

- Sluggish response

Pushpam HandsPC 1300 B-

Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■



Contact details	Brand	Palm Zire and Palm Zire 71	Toshiba Pocket PC e350	Pushpam handsPC 1600/ 1300/ 1100
	Company	Tech Pacific	HCL Infosystem Ltd, Frontline Division	Pushpam Infotech Corporation
	Phone	022-5596 0303	0120- 244 2368	9520 4215162
	E-mail	manishl@techpacindia.com	response@hclinsys.com	sachin@pushpam.com
	website	www.palmone.com	www.pda.toshiba.com	www.pushpam.com